

If you can pay off your mortgage in five years instead of 10, you'll save \$14,000 in interest. If you can pay off your mortgage in five years instead of 20, you'll save \$21,000. But more importantly, the sooner you pay it off, the sooner you can dispense with the 90/10 Rule and save your money for other goals and even spend a little, too.

Money Mistake: *You Can't Afford a Vacation*

The Fix: *Invest Time without the Money*

You've got no business taking luxurious vacations until you've dug yourselves out of debt. In the early days of your marriage, extravagant trips will only sink you into *more* debt, which can seriously undermine your partnership. You don't want that.

But that doesn't mean you shouldn't go on vacations. There are plenty of ways to create special memories with one another without plunging into debt (flip to the end of this chapter for some ideas). One of the most fruitful ways of investing time in one another is to take a few days away and do something special, just the two of you.

I like to say there are two types of vacations. First is the Phase One Vacation. This is the romantic tryst, the adventures you have together *before* you have children. You are building a history, replete with fond recollections and nice photographs. The hope is that the more of these memories you've accrued, the harder it will be to walk away from all the rich history you've built together.